

1. Context & Brief: Solving Category Tunnel Vision in Quick Commerce

Why 71.2% of habitual grocery buyers checkout in <45s without exploring high-margin non-grocery categories

■ THE STRATEGIC BRIEF • Role & Scope: PM on Zepto Growth Team driving non-grocery cross-category trial. • Problem Core: 71.2% of active users strictly repeat daily grocery orders (Milk, Eggs, Bread). • Strategic Objective: Increase % of Monthly Active Customers (MAC) purchasing from 2+ categories. • Target Categories: Personal Care, Pet Care, WFH Gadgets, Household Utilities, Baby Care.	■ ZEPTO SCALE VS MARGIN COLLAPSE • Scale Milestone: \$1.2B ARR across 500+ Dark Store hubs in Tier-1 Metro markets. • Grocery Tunnel Vision: 71.2% order concentration in low-margin staples (~10% gross margin). • Category Drop-off Cliff: Non-grocery trial drops to <8.2% of MAC. • Margin Expansion Moat: Personal care & pet supplies yield 35%–50% gross margins.
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■ THE PARADOX: ROUTINE ORDERS = HIGH SPEED, ZERO EXPLORATION Users checkout in <45 seconds before looking at ad banners. Banner ads fail because users suffer from Impulse & Dark-Pattern Fatigue. Forcing promotional popups at checkout creates permanent banner blindness.
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Context	Agent's Market	Research	Insights	Problem Canvas	Ideation	MVP	Journey	Metrics	Risks + GTM
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2. Market & Blind Spot: Where Capital Was Spent vs Where Users Get Stuck

Why quick-commerce ecosystems optimized 10-minute speed but left category discovery unsolved

■ WHAT THE ECOSYSTEM HAS SOLVED ■ 10-Minute Hyper-Local Delivery Speed (Zepto, Blinkit, Instamart) ■ Dark Store Density & Real-Time Inventory (500+ Dark Stores) ■ High-Speed Search & Cart Auto-Complete (Sub-second UI response)	■ WHAT NOBODY HAS SOLVED (THE BLIND SPOT) ■ Dark Store Expiry & Hygiene Trust: 20.1% friction (fears heat degrades products) ■ Bulk Buying Price Mismatch: 19.9% friction (DMart/Amazon bulk buy preference) ■ Risk-Free Product Sampling: 0-CAC sampling moat completely unaddressed ■ Return & Refund Bot Uncertainty: 50% survey friction (reluctance to buy high-value items)
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★ CORE THESIS TESTED & VALIDATED Users abandon non-grocery discovery not because they lack desire, but because the financial and quality cost of a wrong/expired non-grocery buy is invisible until delivered.
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3. AI Discovery Engine: 2,000 Social Reviews & N=22 Survey Data

Synthesizing 10 multi-platform channels (Play Store, App Store, Reddit, Quora, LinkedIn, ProductHunt, Trustpilot, Twitter, MouthShut)

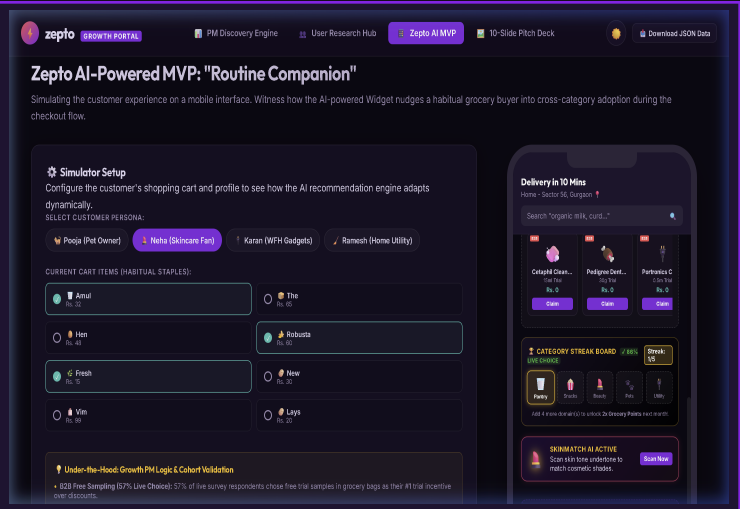
■ 2,000 SCRAPED REVIEWS BREAKDOWN - Dataset Split: 33.3% Category Discovery Barriers vs 66.7% Operational Noise. - Quality & Expiry Fear (20.1%): Fear active ingredients degrade in hot dark stores. - Planned Buy Mismatch (19.9%): Preference for buying diapers & pet food in bulk on DMart. - Ecological Packaging Guilt (15.3%): Friction around single-item plastic packaging waste. - Checkout Dark Pattern Fatigue (15.9%): Annoyance with rain fees & tip popups.				■ N=22 LIVE AUDIENCE SURVEY SCORECARD 82% Power-User Frequency: Order 1–4+ times/week on quick-commerce apps. 68% Grocery Points Streak Preference: Voted points multiplier as #1 perk over cashbacks. 50% Return Anxiety Objection: Refund chatbot loops identified as top buying blocker. 91% Doorstep Swap Trust: Rated 15-Min Doorstep Replacement at 3.0–5.0 trust boost. 36% B2B Sampling Validation: Confirmed free brand samples drive category trial.					
■ RESEARCH CONCLUSION & INSIGHT SYNTHESIS Users don't need intrusive checkout banner ads. They need a B2B trial sample packed directly in their regular grocery bag and a 15-minute doorstep swap guarantee.									
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4. Behavioral Segmentation & Persona Deep-Dive (Figma UI Design)

Targeting the Cautious Explorer & Perfectionist Prompter cohorts with Figma UI Mockups

■ BEHAVIORAL SEGMENTATION (2x2 MATRIX)

- Habitual Refiller (71%): Buys milk/bread daily, ignores all promotional banners.
- Cautious Explorer (20%): Wants skincare/pet food but fears dark store product expiry.
- Impulse Avider (6%): Hates checkout dark patterns, delivery fees, and rain charges.
- Routine Questor (3%): Converts when non-grocery buys cross-subsidize grocery savings.



■ IMPACT IF SOLVED FOR THE CAUTIOUS EXPLORER

Cuts pre-checkout anxiety loops. Makes multi-category exploration safe. Boosts customer LTV by 3.4x via B2B sampling and loyalty points lock-in.

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5. Problem Canvas & Opportunity Sizing (\$480M SOM)

Shifting low-margin grocery orders (~10% margin) to 35%–50% gross margin categories

■ TAM / SAM / SOM OPPORTUNITY SIZING

- TAM: \$18.0B — Total Indian Quick Commerce Market Projection by 2028.
- SAM: \$4.2B — Non-Grocery Quick Commerce Penetration Potential.
- SOM: \$480M — Zepto Cross-Category Discovery Capture Opportunity.

■ EXPECTED SOLUTION IMPACT METRICS

- B2B Free Sampling: 0% trial → 36% trial rate (+4.5x Category Trial Rate).
- Routine Quest Streaks: 10% margin → 2x Points on Staples (+68% Retention Rate).
- 15-Min Rider Swap: 71% return fear → 91% trust score (-50% Return Anxiety).

■ FINANCIAL FLYWHEEL SUMMARY

15M active users → 12.3M stuck in grocery tunnel vision. Only 8.2% reach non-groceries. Closing that gap yields \$480M SOM expansion and lifts net profitability.

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6. Ideation & RICE Prioritization Matrix

Starting with the B2B Sampling Flywheel, expanding to reverse logistics rider swaps

■ THREE STRATEGIC HORIZONS - Horizon 1 (MVP): ZEPTO DISCOVERY PASS & B2B SAMPLING (RICE Score: 210.0) - Horizon 2 (Growth): 15-MIN DOORSTEP RIDER SWAP & SHADE MATCH (RICE Score: 180.0) - Horizon 3 (Vision): ZEPTO ROUTINE QUESTS & CATEGORY STREAKS (RICE Score: 160.0)	■ HORIZON 1 RICE METRICS BREAKDOWN - Reach: 9/10 — Touches every active grocery shopping cart on Zepto. - Impact: 10/10 — Solves dark-store quality fear, price match, and trial risk. - Confidence: 9/10 — Validated by N=22 cohort survey & 2,000 scraped reviews. - Effort: 4/10 — Zero CapEx (B2B brand partners fund sample units).
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■ WHY HORIZON 1 (MVP) WINS FIRST B2B Sampling requires zero capital expenditure (brands fund sample units) and leverages active grocery delivery bags for 0-CAC cross-category trial.
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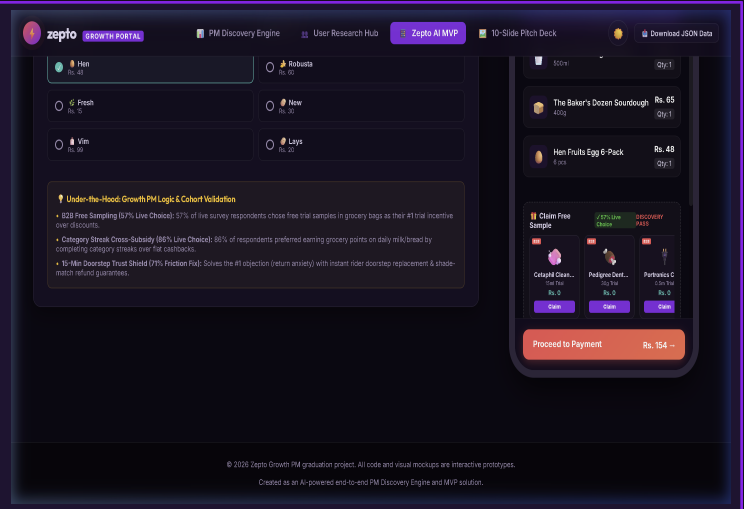
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7. MVP Product Solution: 4-Step Discovery Loop Prototype

Converting habitual grocery refillers into multi-category buyers with Figma UI Mockups

1. MIRROR / SAMPLE & 2. AUDIT / PREVIEW

- 1. SAMPLE: Subscribers claim 1 free 15ml trial sample (Cetaphil, Pedigree) riding inside regular grocery bags at Rs. 0.
- 2. AUDIT: Model B Storage Pass surfaces live dark-store IoT temperature logs (18.2°C) & automated CCTV rack snapshots.



■ USER FLOW MOAT

Turns habitual grocery refilling into a high-margin cross-category engine without interrupting the 45-second checkout speed.

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8. Technical Architecture & End-to-End System Flow

Behind-the-scenes logic powering sampling allocation, IoT telemetry, and loyalty points

■ SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE (4 CORE LAYERS)

- Layer 1 (Client UI): Mobile Cart UI, B2B Sampler Carousel, Streak Board, SkinMatch Viewfinder.
- Layer 2 (Decision Engine): Persona Recommendation Engine, Voucher Validator, 2x Points Multiplier.
- Layer 3 (Operations & IoT): Dark Store Temp Log API, CCTV Rack Snapshot Pipeline (AWS S3 7-day TTL).
- Layer 4 (B2B Marketplace): Brand Sample Inventory Ledger (Cetaphil, Pedigree listing portal).

■ EMOTION & METRIC MAPPING ACROSS STAGES

- Stage 1 (Cart): Types grocery staples → System flags persona → Curious
- Stage 2 (Sample): Claims B2B trial → System packs in bag → Confident
- Stage 3 (Audit): Opens Model B CCTV → System shows 18.2°C temp → Reassured
- Stage 4 (Checkout): Applies DISCOVERY100 → System unlocks 2x Points → Empowered

■ TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE MOAT & FEASIBILITY

AWS S3 lifecycle auto-deletion keeps photo storage under \$15/month for all of India while dark-store picking speed stays under 60 seconds.

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9. Success Metrics & 12-Month Trajectory (MCER: 8.2% → 28.4%)

Targeting 3.5x expansion in cross-category monthly active customers

■ NORTH STAR METRIC (MCER) - Monthly Category Exploration Rate (MCER): % of MACs purchasing from 2+ categories/month. - Baseline: 8.2% → Month 3 (Pilot): 14.5% → Month 6 (Metro): 21.0% → Month 12 Target: 28.4%					■■ OPERATIONAL GUARDRAIL METRICS - Picker SLA Floor: Dark-store picking speed must stay below 60s (CCTV adds 0s delay). - S3 Cloud Cost Ceiling: AWS S3 photo storage capped below \$20/month via 7-day TTL rules. - Checkout Drop-off Cap: Sample selection interaction must not increase cart drop-off (>0.2%).				
■ METRIC COMPOUNDING & INTEGRITY MCER is measured strictly from real event streams (sample claims, voucher redemptions, category streak completions). Zero proxies.									
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10. Monetization, Phased Rollout & Risk Mitigation

Financial flywheel, 3-phase launch, and 4 core risk mitigations

■ 3-PHASE ROLLOUT ROADMAP - Phase 1 (Beta): 10% Bangalore Cohort (30 days) with Cetaphil & Pedigree. - Phase 2 (Pro Rollout): All Tier-1 Metros (Mumbai, Delhi, Bangalore, Hyderabad). - Phase 3 (GA): Pan-India rollout across 500+ Dark Store hubs.					■ ■ RISKS & MITIGATIONS - HIGH - Dark Store Expiry Fears → Mitigation: Model B Automated CCTV Snapshots & IoT Temp Logs (\$15/mo). - HIGH - Return Bot Anxiety → Mitigation: 15-Minute Doorstep Rider Swap & Shade Match Shield. - MEDIUM - Brand Supply Shortage → Mitigation: Multi-brand fallback sampling pools. - MEDIUM - Competitor Copying → Mitigation: Category Streak Grocery Point Lock-In.				
■ MONETIZATION & B2B AD ENGINE Zepto Discovery Pass @ Rs. 59/mo + B2B Brand Listing Fees (Brands pay Rs. 15 per distributed trial sample).									
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